



A PARENT & STUDENT PLANNING GUIDE

The College Apartment Checklist

Everything your student actually needs to move in, settle in, and thrive — organized room by room, with the true essentials flagged so you buy smart, not twice.

Sending a child to college is a milestone — and a logistics project. We built this checklist for the families we work with so the move-in is calm instead of chaotic. Start with **The First 20%** below (the items that make the apartment livable on day one), then work through the room-by-room list. Tip: measure the space and confirm what's already provided before you shop.

The First 20% **BUY THESE FIRST**

If you only handle one list this week, make it this one. These are the items that make the apartment functional and comfortable from night one.

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| ☐ ★ Quality bed sheets, comforter & pillows | ☐ ★ Mattress topper & protector |
| ☐ ★ Bath towels + shower curtain & liner | ☐ ★ Cookware set, knives & cutting board |
| ☐ ★ Dinnerware, flatware & drinkware | ☐ ★ Coffee maker + one key appliance (air fryer) |
| ☐ ★ Trash cans with liners (kitchen + bath) | ☐ ★ Core cleaning kit & vacuum |
| ☐ ★ Laundry hamper & detergent | ☐ ★ Blackout curtains & a good lamp |
| ☐ ★ Under-bed & closet storage bins | ☐ ★ Safety: first aid kit, fire blanket, flashlight |

Bedroom

Comfort, rest, and storage — where it all starts.

BEDDING

- ☐ Bed sheets (100% cotton)
- ☐ Comforter / quilt & blankets
- ☐ Pillows & pillowcases
- ☐ Mattress topper
- ☐ Mattress protector / encasement
- ☐ Bed skirt

FURNITURE & STORAGE

- ☐ Nightstand
- ☐ Bedside lamp
- ☐ Under-bed storage bins
- ☐ Closet organizers (doubblers, shoe shelves)
- ☐ Storage bench
- ☐ Mini fridge (optional)

COMFORT & DÉCOR

- ☐ Blackout curtains
- ☐ Full-length mirror
- ☐ Jewelry / accessory organizer
- ☐ Smart plugs

Bathroom

Small space, high impact — keep it clean and clutter-free.

SHOWER & BATH

- ☐ Shower curtain + liner + rings
- ☐ Shower caddy / shelves
- ☐ Bath mat / rug
- ☐ Quick-dry towels
- ☐ Towel hooks

STORAGE

- ☐ Over-toilet organizer
- ☐ Under-cabinet drawers
- ☐ Countertop organizer
- ☐ Hair-tool organizer + heat mat

CLEAN & SAFE

- ☐ Toilet brush & cleaner
- ☐ Trash can with liners
- ☐ First aid kit
- ☐ Nightlight
- ☐ Damp Rid (moisture control)

Kitchen

The biggest list — and where smart organizing saves the most money and space.

COOKWARE & PREP

- ☐ Non-stick cookware set
- ☐ Knife set & cutting boards
- ☐ Utensil set + holder
- ☐ Measuring cups & spoons
- ☐ Glass baking dishes & sheet pans
- ☐ Can opener, whisk, vegetable chopper

DISHES & DRINKWARE

- ☐ Dinnerware set
- ☐ Flatware / silverware set
- ☐ Bowls & coffee mugs
- ☐ Glasses (pint & wine)

SMALL APPLIANCES

- ☐ Coffee maker (Keurig / drip)
- ☐ Air fryer
- ☐ Toaster or toaster oven
- ☐ Personal blender
- ☐ Crockpot (optional)

FOOD STORAGE & ORGANIZING

- ☐ Glass storage containers
- ☐ Dry-food / pantry containers
- ☐ Pantry & cabinet organizers
- ☐ Brita water dispenser
- ☐ Dish rack & dish towels
- ☐ Paper towel holder

SAFETY & EXTRAS

- ☐ Fire blanket / fire spray
- ☐ Kitchen trash can
- ☐ Simple college cookbook
- ☐ Reusable grocery cart / bag

Living Room & Entryway

For unfurnished or shared spaces — build comfort and storage.

FURNITURE & STORAGE

- ☐ Couch slipcover (if furnished)
- ☐ Coffee table & end table
- ☐ Bookshelf / storage shelving
- ☐ Extra seating
- ☐ Area rug (low-pile)

ENTERTAINMENT & LIGHTING

- ☐ Smart TV + streaming stick
- ☐ Sound bar (optional)
- ☐ Floor lamp / table lamp
- ☐ Wall art & board games

ENTRYWAY

- ☐ Coat rack / hooks
- ☐ Shoe rack or bench
- ☐ Boot / wet tray

Cleaning, Laundry & Safety

The unglamorous list that keeps everything running.

CLEANING

- ☐ Vacuum cleaner
- ☐ Swiffer / mop
- ☐ All-purpose cleaning supplies
- ☐ Small tool kit

LAUNDRY

- ☐ Laundry hamper / basket
- ☐ Detergent & supplies
- ☐ Drying rack (if needed)

SAFETY & SECURITY

- ☐ First aid kit
- ☐ Carbon monoxide detector
- ☐ Fire blanket & flashlight + batteries
- ☐ Door lock reinforcement / Ring
- ☐ Personal safety alarm

COMFORT & MISC

- ☐ Air purifier / humidifier
- ☐ Portable phone charger
- ☐ Umbrella
- ☐ Quick-dry pool / beach towels

Before You Buy — Pro Tips

A few minutes of planning prevents the most common (and expensive) move-in mistakes.

Measure first.

Bed size + mattress depth, closet layout, and room dimensions before ordering furniture or bins.

Divide, don't split.

With roommates, each person owns shared items outright — no cost-splitting to untangle at move-out.

Check the rules.

Wall-hanging and mounting policies vary — confirm before buying art, shelves, or command hooks.

Confirm what's provided.

Microwave, dishwasher, washer/dryer, ice maker — don't double-buy what the unit already has.

Choose safe materials.

Look for OEKO-TEX® textiles and CertiPUR-US certified bedding for non-toxic peace of mind.

Storage is the secret.

Vertical and under-bed storage turns a small apartment into a calm, functional home.

Let Us Handle the Heavy Lifting

This checklist is the easy part. **Organize Palm Beach** can plan, source, measure, and set up your student's apartment so it's move-in ready and beautifully organized from day one — so you can focus on the goodbye hug, not the storage bins.

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